

even before getting our company registered, we got our first order from Aditya Birla Group. We believe in the concept of selling first and then building,” says Sanghapriya. He points out that their business model helped them sustain and even multiply during the pandemic.

On being asked why they chose Gujarat instead of the common Bengaluru for their tech startup, Sanghapriya says, “Everyone goes to Bangalore to try their luck, but we wanted to learn the ‘Dhandha’ the traditional way. Since Gujarat has a strong history of entrepreneurship and adorns a mature startup ecosystem with a proactive and welcoming government, we started with our community-building approach and innovation network there.” He adds, “We were able to run the business for the last four and a half years while being bootstrapped because we learned the art of doing the business, doing the *Dhandha*.”

According to Sanghapriya, *Dhandha* and entrepreneurship are very different things. “We operate as a startup. Our vision, our tech, and our culture are all Bangalore-type, but our economics and our finance are like the traditional *Dhandha*.” The *Dhandha* mindset was clear when we got to know that the company’s R&D team works in Bengaluru. “Where else to find better tech resources?” asks Sanghapriya.



The IG Drones team exhibiting their enterprise drone solutions

IG Drones is also working on the ‘uberisation’ of the entire model on a single software platform—IG One—which is a gamut of 100+ software under one umbrella. The entire drone operation, manpower, and finance will be managed with that software, which is currently undergoing internal testing.

Busting another stereotype, that only aeronautical engineers can fly drones, they have established 60 drone Centres of Excellence (CoE) across India in collaboration with different government and private universities, government bodies like NSDC, industry bodies like FICCI, and industrial conglomerates like Adani and J.K. group. At these centres, people from varied backgrounds are upskilled with drones, simulators, operating procedures, and software.

Such an initiative has equipped IG Drones with multiple partners in the form of micro-entrepreneurs all around the country. It also helped the company to achieve the marvellous feat to mobilize its team within 48 hours, across geographies in India. Going forward, they aspire to upskill, free of cost, one million Indians with drone technology.

IG Drones aims to develop the ‘brain’ of drones here in India. Why? “Let’s take the case of the F-16 that Pakistan purchased from the USA. Any day, the Pentagon can switch off the engine because they own the technology and the control board. Therefore, India needs to become truly *atmanirbhar* in drones by controlling the core tech, and not just suffice with building and colouring beautiful frames,” Sanghapriya responds.

—Vaishali Yadav

3 POWER PLANT THAT CAN BOTH GENERATE AND STORE ENERGY

“Our plants can be thought of as power plants and chemical plants rolled into one very thermally efficient system,” says Vijay Prateik, Founder and CEO, deMITasse Energies

deMITasse Energies is an IIM Bangalore incubated startup in the clean-energy and energy-storage business. The company is

working with some Indian energy companies and is also doing projects with the Indian Navy and the Indian Army. The Delhi based startup

has offices in Bengaluru, Delhi, and New Jersey. The company has created a new type of power plant which is reliable, low-cost, and uses